

CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

ASHIANA ADVIK ▲

Bhiwadi

Ownership: For sale

Facilities: Dining services, activity area, card rooms, table tennis, religious space, walking track, housekeeping

COST

1BHK: Rs 45 lakh
3BHK: Rs 85 lakh
Villas: Rs 2 cr.

MAINTENANCE

Rs 4 per square foot (Rs 3,500–Rs 9,000)



◀ ATHULYA ASSISTED LIVING

Chennai

Ownership: Rental

Facilities: Senior-friendly bed and furniture, accessible buildings and bathrooms, medical facilities, activities and engagement areas

RENT

Rs 55,000–Rs 75,000 per month, inclusive of food

adults over 45 years in India reported moderate loneliness, and 13.3 per cent severe loneliness. "Human beings are social creatures designed for companionship," says Dr Nimesh Desai, a psychiatrist and former director of the Institute of Human Behaviour and Allied Sciences in Delhi. "Having a sense of belonging and community can significantly improve mental well-being." Several studies have shown the negative impact of loneliness on mental health; it can directly cause stress and precipitate the onset of illnesses such as depression, anxiety, dementia, and Alzheimer's.

To address the emotional and social needs of the elderly, many of these service providers offer opportunities to participate in events, learning programmes, social gatherings, etc. to improve not just their quality of life but also to pursue their forgotten passions.

Ashiana, Antara and CovaiCare thus offer two to three activities for seniors each day. On the day Antara Dehradun was screening Dev Anand films, the residents had finished chair yoga in the morning. At Ashiana, Gupta says there are around 150 activities for residents, with music and dance, table tennis and cards being the most popular.

Anjula Ray Chaudhuri, 70, who has been staying at Ashiana Nirmay in Bhiwadi for the past five years, says they offer a wide range of activities, including religious, spiritual, cultural and sporting activities. "Between raising my two daughters, working a full-time job, and taking care of my aged mother, I didn't have time for anything else," she says. It was at Ashiana that she began acting in plays and has already participated in five. Her husband, Mrinal, is now taking keyboard lessons and often performs at their weekly musical evenings.

"The concept of a bucket list is very real for them, and they are excited to talk to people and explore new places," says Asheesh Gupta, co-founder of home eldercare firm Samarth Eldercare. Their care counsellors visit and work with the elderly to help them rediscover forgotten hobbies, volunteer at nearby NGOs and build connections within the community. They work on a subscription model and their packages range from Rs 7,500-15,000 per month.

Emoha has designed its services around an app, as more elders overcome their fear of smartphones. Their most popular feature is MohTV, offering over 4,000 programmes, including doctor talks on bone health, home remedies, gut health, magic shows, breathing techniques and workshops on chakra healing. Real-time sessions generate even more interest. Nearly 500 adults complete their morning chores daily to be in front of the screen by 7.30 am for their daily exercise session. What they look forward to most is the first 15 minutes of general chit-chat with each other before getting into the groove. Conversations